The Coca-Cola Company

3Q24 First Impressions

KO just reported 3Q24 Comparable EPS of $0.77, which bested Consensus of $0.75 and Barclays Research $0.74. A stronger top line than we had modelled flowed through favorably, and we also estimate a 1c benefit from below-the-line.

CORE

KO	OVERWEIGHT
U.S. CHPC & Beverages	NEUTRAL
Price Target	USD 74.00
Price (22-Oct-24)	USD 69.45
Potential Upside/Downside	+6.6%

U.S. CHPC & Beverages
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Our Thoughts

Despite caution at our Conference in early September around top-line growth, KO posted better-than-expected results for organic sales and EPS growth this morning. To be sure, while revenues again benefitted from greater pricing than we'd anticipated in Argentina, our math suggests total company sales still would have come in comfortably ahead of Consensus estimates even if price/mix in Latam had been in line with our forecasts. More specifically, the overage contributed 1.4 points to the company's 9% organic sales growth, which was ~3-points ahead of Consensus. Taking a step back, given the litany of negative consumer commentary that is beginning to come through this earnings season, we expect the steadiness and strength of KO's top- and bottom-line performance should stand out and warrant narrowing of the valuation gap between it and other, large-cap multi-national Staples names.

Highlights

- Organic sales +9% vs. our +6%, driven by a 4-point price/mix beat
  - LatAm, North America and APAC each outperformed our expectations by mid-single to low-double digit rates

Lowlights

- Unit case volumes -1% vs. our +1%
- Gross margins +70 bps vs. our +160 bps, with FX proving a bigger headwind than we modelled, although operating margins +105 bps was in line with our forecast

2024 Guidance

- Updated:
  - Organic revenue ~10% (from +9-10% & vs. us & Consensus at +10.1%)
  - FX headwind of ~5% on net revenues (from 5-6% & vs. us & Consensus -5.1%) & ~9% drag on comparable EPS (from 8-9%)
  - Effective tax rate 18.8 (from 19.0%), not including impact of ongoing tax litigation
  - Comparable constant currency EPS +14-15% (from +13-15%)
- Maintained:
  - Structural headwind of ~4-5% on net revenues and a 1-2% drag on comparable EPS
  - Comparable EPS +5-6% that implies $2.82-$2.85 (vs. our $2.84 and Consensus $2.85)
  - All cash flow & capex metrics

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4Q24 Guidance

- Net revenue headwinds: FX ~4% (our -4.1%); structural ~4-5% (our -5.9%)
- Comparable EPS headwinds: FX ~10%; structural ~3-4%

2025 Guidance

- FX headwind: net revenue LSD; comparable EPS MSD (vs. our -0.4%)
- Elevated interest expense due to debt issued for tax litigation deposit

and Fairlife contingent consideration

KO 3Q24 Earnings Call Details:

Today @ 8:30 AM ET - U.S. Dial: 1-888-415-4465; International: 1-646-960-0140; Passcode: 6819315.

As always, please feel free to call with any questions or comments.

Best,

Lauren

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Primary Stocks (Ticker, Date, Price)
The Coca-Cola Company (KO, 22-Oct-2024, USD 69.45), Overweight/Neutral, A/CD/CE/D/E/J/K/L/M/N

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U.S. CHPC & Beverages

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Constellation Brands (STZ)	Coty Inc. (COTY)	Duckhorn Portfolio Inc (NAPA)
Edgewell Personal Care Company (EPC)	Energizer Holdings, Inc (ENR)	International Flavors & Fragrances (IFF)
Keurig Dr Pepper (KDP)	Kimberly-Clark Corp. (KMB)	Molson Coors Beverage Company (TAP)

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The Coca-Cola Company (KO)	The Estée Lauder Companies (EL)	

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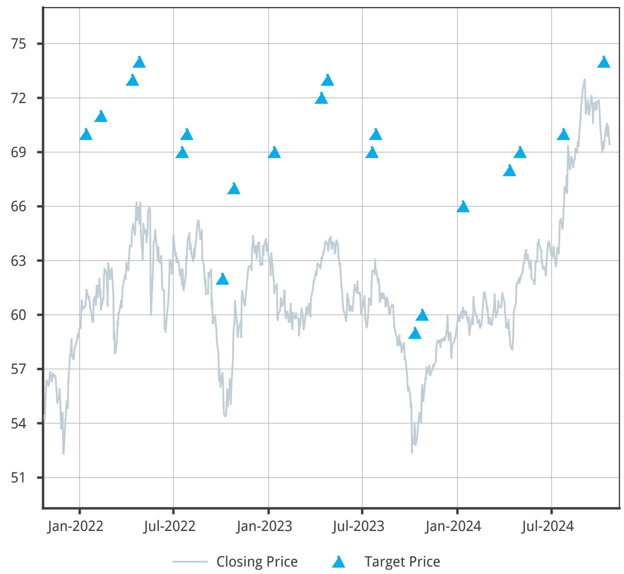
Stock Rating: **OVERWEIGHT**

Industry View: **NEUTRAL**

Closing Price: **USD 69.45** (22-Oct-2024)

Rating and Price Target Chart - USD (as of 22-Oct-2024)

Currency=USD



Source: IDC, Barclays Research

Link to Barclays Live for interactive charting

Publication Date	Closing Price*	Rating	Adjusted Price Target
10-Oct-2024	69.57		74.00
24-Jul-2024	64.96		70.00
01-May-2024	61.77		69.00
11-Apr-2024	59.72		68.00
12-Jan-2024	59.81		66.00
25-Oct-2023	55.64		60.00
11-Oct-2023	54.03		59.00
27-Jul-2023	63.05		70.00
20-Jul-2023	61.64		69.00
25-Apr-2023	63.95		73.00
13-Apr-2023	62.69		72.00
12-Jan-2023	61.21		69.00
26-Oct-2022	58.95		67.00
04-Oct-2022	56.78		62.00
27-Jul-2022	63.21		70.00
18-Jul-2022	61.65		69.00
26-Apr-2022	65.94		74.00
13-Apr-2022	64.73		73.00
11-Feb-2022	61.38		71.00
13-Jan-2022	60.90		70.00

On 23-Oct-2021, prior to any intra-day change that may have been published, the rating for this security was Overweight, and the adjusted price target was 63.00.

Source: Bloomberg, Barclays Research

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Valuation Methodology: Our price target of $74 is based on a ~24.6x P/E reflecting a +25% premium to Large-Cap Staples peers on our CY25 EPS estimate of $3.01.

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